

Throughout my academic journey, I have been captivated by the intricate tapestry of the business world and its dynamic interplay with global economies. My fascination with the field began to take shape during a summer job at a local cafe, Caruso Café Boutique, where I worked as a waitress, cashier and stock clerk. Although it may seem like a modest start, it was during this experience that I first glimpsed the inner workings of business operations, from inventory management to customer service.

Through Caruso Café, I learned about the day-to-day challenges faced by small business owners. This exposure not only honed my interpersonal skills but also deepened my appreciation for the resilience required in the business world. The relations that my team had developed with clients made me realise that even small enterprises play a vital role in their communities, and their success depends on a combination of smart decision-making and adaptability.

In addition to my summer job, my academic journey has been marked by a relentless pursuit of excellence. My coursework in economics and mathematics has provided me with a strong analytical foundation. Beyond the classroom, I participated in a school-wide entrepreneurship competition, where my team and I developed a business plan for the sustainable agriculture startup Light Science Technologies. This hands-on experience taught me the importance of innovation, teamwork, and effective communication in turning an idea into a viable business venture.

Furthermore, my commitment to community engagement has led me to volunteer at Derby City Mission Food Bank. This experience allowed me to witness the impact of resource allocation, logistics, and supply chain management on the organization's ability to serve the community efficiently. It reinforced my belief in the practical application of business principles to solve real-world challenges and the skills required to do so.

Beyond this, I have also sought to expand my horizons through independent research. In one project, I delved into the ever-evolving field of e-commerce, examining the strategies employed by online retailers to optimize customer engagement. This research deepened my understanding of the digital marketplace and its disruptive potential. Additionally, I have actively sought out mentorship opportunities by participating in programmes such as Pathways to Business, attending workshops and networking events to learn from seasoned professionals who have navigated the complexities of starting and running their own businesses.

I am committed to furthering my education and experiences in business, with a particular interest in exploring sustainable business practices and the role of technology in shaping the future of commerce. I am confident that the knowledge, skills, and passion I bring to this field will allow me to contribute meaningfully and drive positive change within the business community and society as a whole.